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Dear Hiring Manager,

The Employment Legal Assistant role at your Thatcham firm appeals to me because my background spans exactly the kind of work an employment team handles day to day: case file management, tribunal preparation, client correspondence and working to tight procedural deadlines. I have spent the past year advising clients at Citizens Advice East Berkshire on employment matters as well as welfare benefits, housing and debt, which has given me direct exposure to employment law in practice and a clear sense of how tribunal processes work from a client's perspective.

At Citizens Advice I manage each matter from initial instruction through to submission. That means taking detailed factual statements, identifying the relevant legal issues, preparing correspondence and applications, and maintaining confidential case records throughout. Employment queries regularly involve dismissal, discrimination and contractual disputes, and because many clients have little prior experience of legal proceedings, I translate procedural requirements into plain terms so they can make informed decisions. That combination of file management and client-facing communication is exactly what a busy employment team needs from a legal assistant.

Before Citizens Advice, I spent a year as a placement student at BCLP in London, six months of which was in Real Estate Disputes. There I supported hearing preparation directly: reviewing documents, preparing electronic bundles, assisting with skeleton arguments and court materials, and tracking deadlines across several matters running simultaneously. I also handled administrative steps including court filings, matter opening and closure, and cost comparisons, using iManage to maintain matter records. The experience of keeping multiple files moving accurately and on time, under the supervision of partners and associates, gave me a practical grounding in the kind of legal support work this role involves.

Thatcham is close to Maidenhead, where I already work, so the location is genuinely practical for me and I am looking for a role I can commit to long term. An employment team focused on tribunal work is a natural next step: it builds directly on the employment advisory work I do now and the procedural and file-management experience I built at BCLP. I would welcome the chance to develop that further in a dedicated legal support role.

Yours sincerely,
Maria Silva